Merits of Visible Card Index:

1. Speedy reference is possible as the names of the customers or subject are all visible.

2. Though visible indexing costs more, it saves time and labour much that it offsets the additional cost.

3. Additional information can be easily written on the cards even without disturbing the order in which they have been kept.

4. Cards can be removed and inserted with great ease.

5. Visible card indexing is very compact as a large number of cards can be accommodated in every tray.

Demerits of Visible Card Index:

1. The visible card index equipment is costlier than the equipment required for card index.

2. The filing staff must be trained properly for its operation.

2. Strip Index:

It is a type of visible indexing which is used when the entries are limited to a few lines (names, addresses, etc ;). It consists of a frame into which strips of stiff paper can be fixed in any required order. Each strip is devoted to one name only. Frames containing these strips may be either fixed on the wall or arranged on a rotary stand which can be turned round to look at any part of the index. These strips can be protected from exposure or damage by using removable transparent celluloid covers.

3. Wheel Index:

It is an improvement over visible card index. Cards are arranged about the circumference of the wheel. A single wheel can hold as many as 1000 cards. Cards can be inserted into or taken out of the slits of the metal rod whenever needed. An entry can be made on the card by applying the brakes to keep the wheel fixed. Thus, entries can be made on the cards and cards can be referred to without removing them from the wheel.



Fig. 5.12. Wheel Index

Merits of Wheel Index:

1. Wheel index makes reference very easy and quick. It saves time and efforts.

2. It is economical in space as a large number of cards can be accommodated in a wheel.

3. Entries can be made on the cards without removing them from the wheel.

4. New cards can be added and old ones removed without much difficulty. Thus wheel index allows flexibility in operations.

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